

A sentence is a group of words with a subject and a predicate that has a finite verb and makes a complete sense or thought on its own. It starts with a capital letter and ends with either a full stop (.), a question mark (?) or an exclamation mark (!)

CHARACTERISTICS OF A SENTENCE*

It is a group of words.

It has a subject and a predicate.

It has a finite verb.

It starts with a capital letter.

It ends with a full stop, a question mark or an exclamation mark.

It makes a complete sense or thought on its own.

Study these:

I have Kola.

Proverbs are the palm oil with which words are eaten.

Is he staying long with us?

Do what you are told, woman!

The sentences above start with capital letters and end with a full stop, a question mark and an exclamation mark respectively. They also possess subjects, predicates and finite verbs.

TYPES OF SENTENCE

There are two broad types of sentences, namely;

i Types of sentences according to function

ii. Types of sentences according to structure

One is the grouping of sentences based on the functions they are used to perform, while the other is the grouping of sentences based on their structures.

TYPE OF SENTENCE ACCORDING TO FUNCTIONS

This is the grouping of sentences according to the function they are used to perform.

DECLARATIVE SENTENCE:

This is a kind of sentence that is used to express a thought, an idea or a statement e.g.



- a. The boy closed the door.
- b. The car is for sale.
- c. A banker bought the new house.

INTERROGATIVE SENTENCE:

These kinds of sentences are used for asking question or making an enquiry e.g.

- a. Do you know his father?
- b. Have they built their house?
- c. Who are his parents?

IMPERATIVE SENTENCE:

This is a kind sentence that is used to make a command, request or suggestion e.g.

- a. Open the door at once!
- b. May I use your phone?
- c. We should help the poor.

DEMONSTRATIVE SENTENCES:

This kind of sentence points out the position of objects (things or person)

- a. This is the man.
- b. Those managers are corrupt.
- c. These are my books.

EXCLAMATORY SENTENCE:

This kind of sentence expresses some strong or sudden feeling.

- a. What a beauty!
- b. How brilliant Victoria is!
- c. What a shame!

OPTATIVE SENTENCE:

This kind of sentence expresses a wish, supposition or probability.



- a. We wish she could be with us
- b. He ought to have been married by now.
- c. If wishes were horses, beggars would ride.

